

# RANK FILES

## THE “TO + V-ING” TRAP

### MASTER THIS ONCE.

Whenever **to** is a preposition, the word after it cannot be a bare verb. Use a noun or **V-ing (gerund)**.

### Common expressions you should know

| Expression      | Correct pattern                            |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------|
| dedicated to    | dedicated to <b>serving</b> the nation     |
| look forward to | look forward to <b>meeting</b> you         |
| accustomed to   | accustomed to <b>working</b> late          |
| committed to    | committed to <b>improving</b> the system   |
| object to       | object to <b>paying</b> extra              |
| opposed to      | opposed to <b>changing</b> the rule        |
| devoted to      | devoted to <b>helping</b> others           |
| used to         | used to <b>waking</b> up early             |
| addicted to     | addicted to <b>playing</b> games           |
| look forward to | looking forward to <b>hearing</b> from you |

**Exam alert:** Do not blindly apply “to + V1”. First identify what kind of *to* you are looking at.

# WHY DOES THIS HAPPEN?

The real reason: “to” has two different jobs.

## JOB 1 — INFINITIVE MARKER

to + V1

I want **to learn**.

She decided **to leave**.

Here “to” introduces a verb.

## JOB 2 — PREPOSITION

to + noun / pronoun / V-ing

She is dedicated **to education**.

She is dedicated **to teaching**.

Here “to” behaves like a preposition.

## The golden logic

Preposition → noun

to + education ✓

to + teaching ✓ (teaching = gerund, noun-like)

to + teach ✗

## So why V-ing?

A gerund is a verb form ending in **-ing** that can function like a noun. Therefore, after a preposition, **V-ing** fits the grammatical slot.

**Think like this:** “I am dedicated to WHAT?” → teaching.

“I look forward to WHAT?” → meeting you.

# ERROR HUNTER

Compare the structures. Spot exactly **why** the error occurs.

## ERROR

■ I am looking forward to **meet** you.

## WHY?

"to" = preposition → cannot take bare V1.

## CORRECT

■ I am looking forward to **meeting** you.

## ERROR

■ She is dedicated to **help** children.

## WHY?

"to" = preposition → use a noun/gerund.

## CORRECT

■ She is dedicated to **helping** children.

## ERROR

■ He is accustomed to **work** late.

## WHY?

"to" = preposition in "accustomed to".

## CORRECT

■ He is accustomed to **working** late.

## ERROR

■ They objected to **paying** the fee.

## WHY?

The intended form is a gerund; do not confuse its spelling with a bare verb.

## CORRECT

■ They objected to **paying** the fee.

## ■ FINAL EXAM RULE

DON'T ASK: "Does the sentence have 'to'?"

ASK: "Is this 'to' an infinitive marker or a preposition?"

If it is a **preposition** → V-ing.

If it is an **infinitive marker** → V1.